



The Canon A80 is the only camera to offer tilt-screen feature

What They Offered

Despite offering smart features, cameras such as the Sony P100, Canon's IXUS IIs and the HP R707 came in a very compact form and were well supported with good build quality. The Sony P100 and the HP R707 impressed with their extremely solid build quality.

The Samsung U-CA 3 weighed just 125 gms, followed by Kodak's LS743 at 165 gms. The Kodak DX6490 at 380 gms and the Canon A80 at 300 gms—despite being heavier—have exceptional ergonomics.

The Kodak DX7630 has a 6.2 megapixel support. With this, the camera shot at a 2,872 x 2,160 pixel resolution, by far the highest resolution. If you happen to own an A3 photo-printer such as the Canon i9950, then marrying it to the Kodak is a good prospect. Both the Sony models and the HP R707 were 5.1 megapixel cameras. Although the Canon IXUS IIs and Samsung U-CA 3 offered just 3.2 megapixel resolution, they were priced higher than the Sony P100 and the Kodak LS743, which had better features.

As for optical zoom, nothing came close to Kodak's DX6490 and its 10X. For the motherboard

Casio Exilim Ex-Z30 is compact with a bigger LCD than the rest. However, the camera tends to get warm if used continuously. This could damage the internal electronics in the long run

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shoot, the zoom let us capture the tiny metal contacts which form the walls of a PCI slot on the motherboard. The others averaged at 3X optical zoom except for the myopic 2X of the Canon IXUS II.

Manual focus is considered a high-end feature for this category and was, therefore, unexpected. But the Canon A80 did offer it. Manual focus gives greater control to the user when taking extreme close ups. Even though the manual focusing is controlled electronically, it is not as precise as it is in SLR cameras.

The Canon A80 had the shortest macro focus distance of 5 cm, followed by the Samsung V5, which offered a 6 cm distance. The

5 cm, coupled with manual focusing, makes way for wonderful close ups and macros. The HP had the minimum of 39 cm for macro focus, which is too far from the subject to capture details.

An electronic view-finder is a useful, power-saving feature that is extensively used by professionals. EVF as it is known, also helps in stabilising the camera while taking photographs. Unfortunately, only the Kodak DX6490 came with an EVF. The use of EVF balances the high power-consumption arising from constantly adjusting the zoom.

ISO settings can do wonders for the images, if used properly. Higher the sensitivity, the better the image quality and sharpness. Higher sensitivity, however, asks for lots of stability from the photographer and therefore ISO 400 and above should only be used if the camera is either mounted on a tripod or if it is resting on something. The Kodak DX6490 was the only camera that offered high a ISO setting.

Since these cameras offers high-resolution images, you need enough memory to store them. From amongst the models



The Canon A80



Electronic View Finder

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